The Wrench Studios presents

THE ICEBOX

Written by Master Freeze

Issue #7: Top Loopstation Tracks

In the last issue of the Icebox, I introduced the concept of beatbox-based loopstation artistry, which is undeniably one of the coolest forms of music production out there. A loopstation is a digital system that extends the instrument of beatboxing by enabling modulation, layering, effects, and crazy track-building.

In this issue, I want to highlight my favorite loopstation artists and some of their most iconic tracks. I highly recommend you give them a listen if you are into electronic music such as EDM, techno, psytrance, hardstyle, dubstep, or metal.

- **MAHIRO 🇯🇵 - The Demon from Japan**

Mahiro is absolutely my favorite loopstation artist. He initially caught my attention at the start of 2024 when I watched the results of Japan Loopstation Championship 2023 and witnessed total insanity. Then, he had a generational run in 2025 when judging JLC2025, winning BeatCity 2025, and placing 3rd at GBB2025 and 2nd this year. He also created an album “Started my RPG” in April, 2025 to signal his entry into the battle scene.

“Megalodon VIP” is a new version of his “Megalodon” that is made with only the BOSS RC-505 MKII device. He submitted this as a wildcard for BeatCity 2025, instantly grabbing everyone’s attention by its immaculate sound design and sequencing. The way Mahiro uses a loopstation device is very unique, and he had jaws dropping. (Jaws…Megalodon…see what I did there?) It also helps that I love sharks.🦈

“Megalodon VIP” is probably my favorite loopstation track of all time just because of how iconic it is, and the fact that it brings memories. I attended BeatCity 2025 live and was able to experience Mahiro’s first live performance of the round. It hits 100 times harder in-person, as if it wasn’t already insane.

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Another track he debuted at this event was “Goliath”, a final-boss type of track with elements of riddim, choir, and a full thirty second sequence at the end where Mahiro becomes a magician. He steps away from the loopstation completely and uses his hands to control the crowd and to destroy his opponent. As if “Megalodon VIP” wasn’t enough, he continued to terrify future loopstation opponents with this wizardry.

Mahiro’s entire GBB suite is also on my list of favorite tracks. “Lesson vs JUNNO” is a new version of his previous “Lesson” and is a custom-made track where Mahiro works with the crowd to defeat his friend and rival, Junno from Japan. Mahiro does something similar with “Dear Lennard” to battle Lennard from Germany.

Then, “Renegade” is another track with similar themes to Goliath, but it hits so much harder. The riddim drop is completely nasty and the final thirty seconds have you feeling like it's the end of the world. Not to mention the stage presence Mahiro is able to develop with such a monstrous track.

“Overdrive”, “Chains”, “IQZERO”, “Accelerator”, and “Berserker” are all tracks from Mahiro’s runs in GBB25 and GBB26. But this year, his most insane rounds were “Rumble” and “Take Your Mind”. The first features heavy drum patterns, riddim, and extremely heavy basses. The second is a completely new story, a new style, and makes Mahiro even more terrifying. He turns his kick drums into sine wave patterns and incorporates metal themes like a guitar bass and screams.

To summarize Mahiro, my top three tracks are “Megalodon VIP”, “Renegade”, and “Goliath” but I also really enjoy all of his rounds from GBB. Some other tracks worth mentioning for everyday listening are “Overdrive”, “Lesson vs JUNNO”, “Chains”, “Frozen Night”, “HEADBANG”, “Saving”, “REMNANT”, “Chronos”, “Cannon Fire”, and “Retro Trip!”

I only went into this much detail with Mahiro because he is my favorite looper. To be honest, there is still much to say about him. For now, I am looking forward to seeing him win GBB, which I really believe will happen next year.

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- **Yaswede 🇧🇪 - The Chad Troll**

Next up is Yaswede from Belgium, a looper who is not only very talented, but really knows how to troll people and battle his opponents. He is also a bodybuilder and has even taken off his shirt on stage to show off his physique to a cover of ZYZZ.

“Playground” is his most iconic track that features hardstyle and the iconic “forgot the kick” drop that has people moving up and down. Yaswede has even filmed a music video for this track in Japan.

My most favorite tracks of his are “Textures”, “Guess Who’s Back”, and “Reality Check”. His GBB rounds are not all released as tracks, but his 2024 quarterfinal round 1 against Josh-O and 2025 round 2 against DICE are very great to replay.

- **DICE 🇰🇷 - The Genius from Korea**

Dice is known for his phenomenal sound design in his loop tracks, from bank vaults, phone ringtones, laser guns, and alarms to choirs, guitars, and ambience. After his military service in 2024, he had a glow-up and came back to the GBB stage with intent to kill, but he also has tracks that are very soothing.

“THE CODE” is his most iconic track, which is a thematic song from start to finish about “entering the code” and trying to hack into a system which turns out to be a trap.

For his more intense rounds, “Fireboard” and the rest of his GBB 2025 rounds are worth mentioning. That is, round 2 against Syjo, both rounds against Yaswede, and his first round against Martin Benati. These are all unreleased tracks, but super amazing.

For his calm rounds, I absolutely recommend “Anxiety” and his second round against Martin Benati. They are both emotionally-driven loop-tracks where Dice highlights his own feelings about music and performance.

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- **Raje 🇮🇳 - The Technical Innovator**

Raje is a looper that has pushed the capabilities of the MKII to the maximum, often producing tracks that are so intense and complex that people become confused and amazed at the same time. After taking a break following his third-place in GBB2024 and unfortunate waves of negativity from the community, he returned to competition this year and claimed a well-deserved first-place in GBB2026.

Absolutely everything he has put out this year instantly became some of my favorite loop tracks, such as “Press”, “Cheese”, and “Migraine”. Even before that, his GBB2024 set is spectacular, especially “I’m not me”, “Behemoth”, and “Surface Tension”.

It’s clear Raje is much happier as a looper now, as he felt he had something to prove to his haters for the way he conducts looping. I know that means his music will only improve even more in the future.

- **Other Loopstation Tracks**

“Twice” - Robin, GBB2023 against DICE
“Pedestal”, “Metatron”, “Requiem VIP”, “Round and Round” - Martin Benati
“Fall” - Frosty
“Fade Away” - 808Banon
“Quarterfinal Round 1” - Matej, GBB2024 against 808Banon
“ORAS”, “WAVE”, “Piegas” - SARO
“Callista”, “Orthopnea”, “Sullam” - MOKBAY
“Magic”, “Kasugai” - Sora’
“Peppa Pig”, “Megu Megu Fire” - Duncan

This is not an exhaustive list of ones I enjoy. Many Japanese loopers have caught my attention, such as Tako, Taro, Tamro, Ruse, Impedance, and Yamasou.

Producer tracks are another story, as mentioned in the last issue of the Icebox. Please give all of the aforementioned tracks a listen, it will help you become cool.